

Grad Project Solution Framework

Every product prompt has two spaces — problem space(one long thought), solution space(one long thought)

Problem Space:

Business outcome: Which business outcome are we focused on?

Increase wishlist-to-purchase conversion: the percentage of users who purchase at least one item from their wishlist within 30 days of adding it.(business metric)

Why?

Improving wishlist-to-purchase conversion could increase purchase frequency, improve monetization from existing users, and help the company extract greater value from high-intent demand already present on the platform.(lagging indicators)

Why users aren't purchasing at least one wishlisted items within 30 days of adding it?

Look at the **user journey**

Which product outcomes(=user actions, =user behaviour) leads to an increase in wishlist-to-purchase conversion? (map out the product's user flow; KPI tree) (We solve for business outcome by defining as a function of human behaviour(product outcomes)) (Product outcomes gets translated into themes in the roadmap) (leading indicators)

Business metric breakdown into user behaviour/actions/product outcomes:

▼ wishlist-to-purchase conversion

- # users who added an item in wishlist while browsing
 - # users who searched/browsed for an item
 - browse-to-wishlist %
- # users purchasing atleast one item within 30 days of adding it
 - # wishlist page opens
 - # app opens
 - % wishlist button clicks
 - % users who purchased a wishlisted item
 - # users who purchased via 'buy now'
 - # users who purchased via 'add to bag'
 - # users who added the wishlisted item in the bag
 - % users who clicked on 'add-to-bag'
 - # users who found the item they were searching in the wishlist
 - # users who opened the wishlist
 - % of users who found the item/clicked on the product item that they were searching for
 - # users who purchased an item once it is added in the bag
 - # users who opens the bag after the wishlisted item is added
 - # users who purchase the bag items

Desired product outcomes:

▼ A. Recall/discovery problem: % of wishlist-adders who open the wishlist within 30 days. People who didn't open the wishlist.

Stage A — Recall / Discovery

Metric: % of wishlist-adders who open the wishlist within 30 days

Population: saved an item, never came back to the list

Sub-theme	Hypotheses	Barrier in the user's words	Root cause
A1. No trigger to return	Recall H1	"I forgot I even had a wishlist"	List is write-only — it never reaches back out
	(new)	"Nothing told me anything had changed"	No price/stock/low-inventory signal
	(new)	"It was one tap while scrolling"	Save never encoded as a decision
A2. Access friction	Recall H2	"I don't know where the wishlist lives"	Entry point buried in nav
	(new)	"I saved on phone, I shop on laptop"	Cross-device / logged-out saves
A3. No reason to return	(new)	"It's the same list as last time"	Static list, no new information since save
	(new)	"I just search for it again"	Users re-enter via feed/search instead

▼ B. Wishlist-level problem: % of users who found the item/clicked on the product item that they were searching for. People who couldn't locate their item in the wishlist once they open it.

Stage B — Wishlist-level

Metric: % of wishlist-openers who click into the item they came for

Population: opened the list, couldn't get to the item

Sub-theme	Hypotheses	Barrier	Root cause
B1. Retrieval failure at scale	H1	"I can't find the kurta I saved last month"	No sort, filter, or search within wishlist
	H1	"Old stuff is at the bottom forever"	Reverse-chronological only
	(new)	"It's one long undifferentiated grid"	No grouping by category, occasion, or intent
B2. Dead inventory clutter	H1	"Half of it is sold out"	OOS items still occupy the grid
	(new)	"This one just vanished"	Delisted products, brand exits
	(new)	"I've saved the same thing three times"	No duplicate detection
B3. Recognition failure	(new)	"I don't remember why I saved this"	Thumbnail-only, no save context
	(new)	"Which colour did I want?"	Variant not preserved on the tile

▼ C. Item-level problem: % of users who click 'Add to Bag' once they've opened the item from their wishlist. People who didn't click on add to bag once they have located their item in the wishlist.

Stage C — Item-level

Metric: % of item-viewers who click 'Add to Bag'

Population: found the item, opened it, didn't add it

This is where your sub-themes become candidate segments, so it needs the most depth.

Sub-theme	Code	Hypothesis — why the drop-off occurs	What you'd see in feedback data	No-money solvable
C1. Fit & size uncertainty	C1.1	The user cannot determine which size to order because sizing varies across brands, so their usual size is not a reliable guide	"I'm M in one brand and L in another"	Yes
	C1.2	The size chart is in measurements the user doesn't know for themselves, or can't translate into how a garment will sit	"What does 38 chest even mean for me"	Yes
	C1.3	The user's proportions differ from standard grading, so no size fits well and they can't judge which compromise to accept	"Fits my waist but not my hips"	Yes
	C1.4	A previous size-related return has made the user unwilling to risk ordering without certainty	"Last time I had to return two of these"	Yes
C2. Material & digital-physical gap	C2.1	The user cannot judge fabric weight, drape, opacity or texture from photographs	"Is this see-through? Is it thick?"	Yes
	C2.2	The user expects the delivered colour to differ from what the screen shows	"The colour never matches the picture"	Yes
	C2.3	The user suspects photos are styled, pinned or retouched, so the garment won't look as shown	"Looks pinned at the back"	Yes
	C2.4	The user doubts build quality — stitching, finish, hardware — at this price point	"For 799 the quality will be bad"	Yes
	C2.5	The user is unsure whether the listing or seller is authentic, especially for branded items	"Is this a first copy?"	Partly
C3. Styling & self-image	C3.1	The user cannot picture the item on their own body rather than on the model	"It'll look different on me"	Yes
	C3.2	The user doesn't know what to pair it with, or whether they own the complementary pieces	"What would I even wear this with"	Yes
	C3.3	The user judges it too single-use — one occasion, no repeat wear	"Where would I wear it twice"	Yes
	C3.4	The user suspects they already own something similar and can't justify a near-duplicate	"I have three black kurtas already"	Yes
	C3.5	The user is unsure whether the style is current or already past its peak	"Is this still in?"	Yes
C4. External validation & social proof	C4.1	On-platform reviews are too few, too old, or lack photos to resolve the doubt	"Only 4 reviews, no pictures"	Yes
	C4.2	Reviews exist but don't address the user's specific question (fit on a given body type, wash behaviour)	"Nobody says if it shrinks"	Yes
	C4.3	Negative reviews are present and the user can't tell whether the complaint applies to their case	"One person said it tore — is that just them?"	Yes
	C4.4	The user leaves the app to seek external evidence and the session ends without returning	Reddit/YouTube threads asking about specific listings	Yes — highest value

Sub-theme	Code	Hypothesis — why the drop-off occurs	What you'd see in feedback data	No-money solvable
	C4.5	The user sends the item to a friend, partner or group for an opinion and no reply arrives in time	"Sent it to my sister, she never replied"	Yes
	C4.6	The user receives negative feedback from their social circle and drops the item	"My friend said it looks cheap"	Partly
C5. Comparison & decision load	C5.1	Several near-substitutes are saved with no way to view them side by side, so the set never narrows	"I have five white shirts saved"	Yes
	C5.2	Attributes are described inconsistently across brands, so like-for-like comparison isn't possible	"One says regular fit, one says relaxed"	Yes
	C5.3	The volume of saved items exceeds the user's willingness to evaluate, so they defer rather than choose	"I just close it, too much"	Yes
	C5.4	The user believes a better option may still exist and keeps searching rather than committing	"Let me check a few more"	Yes
C6. Price, value & anchoring	C6.1	The price has risen since saving, and the saved price anchors the current one as a loss	"It was 1,199 when I saved it"	Partly — transparency only
	C6.2	The user can't judge whether the current price is fair, having no reference for what it should cost	"Is 2,000 reasonable for this?"	Partly
	C6.3	The user has found the same or a comparable item cheaper elsewhere	Cross-platform price comparison posts	Partly
	C6.4	The user is waiting for a discount that may never come, because sales have taught them to wait	"There's always a sale next month"	No
	C6.5	The item sits above the user's budget band for that category	"Too expensive for a top"	No
C7. Fulfilment, returns & trust	C7.1	A previous poor delivery or return experience has reduced willingness to commit	"Last order came damaged"	Partly
	C7.2	The return process is perceived as costly in time or effort, so uncertainty becomes intolerable	"Returns are such a hassle"	Partly
	C7.3	The item is non-returnable or non-exchangeable, raising the cost of being wrong	Policy visible on PDP	Partly — disclosure
	C7.4	The estimated delivery date falls after the date the user needs the item	"Won't arrive before the function"	Partly
	C7.5	The user doesn't trust the specific seller on this listing	"Seller rating is low"	Partly
C8. Availability at decision time	C8.1	The user's size is out of stock at the moment of consideration	"Sold out in my size again"	No — alerts only
	C8.2	The colour or variant wanted is unavailable and alternatives aren't acceptable	"Only the pink one left"	No
	C8.3	Only sizes adjacent to the user's are available and they can't judge the tolerance	"Only S and L, I'm M"	Partly

Sub-theme	Code	Hypothesis — why the drop-off occurs	What you'd see in feedback data	No-money solvable
	C8.4	The item isn't deliverable to the user's pincode	"Not serviceable in my area"	No
	C8.5	The item is delisted or the brand has exited, leaving a stale listing	Items vanishing from wishlists	No
C9. Intent deferred by an external condition	C9.1	Saved for a dated future occasion (wedding, festival, trip); deferral beyond 30 days is correct behaviour	"Saving this for my cousin's wedding"	Partly — timing aids
	C9.2	Waiting for a known upcoming sale event and unwilling to buy at current price	"Waiting for EORS"	No
	C9.3	Waiting for the salary or income cycle before committing	"After the 1st"	No
	C9.4	Waiting for a restock in their size and checking back periodically	"Been waiting for M to come back"	Partly
	C9.5	The purchase requires approval from a partner, parent or shared-budget holder that hasn't been obtained	"Need to ask my husband"	Partly
C10. Intent never existed	C10.1	Saved as visual reference or inspiration for a look, with no intention to buy	"Using it as a mood board"	No — and shouldn't be
	C10.2	Saved aspirationally — desired, but priced far outside what the user expects to spend	"One day I'll own this"	No
	C10.3	Saved to dismiss it from the feed — a soft "no" rather than a "maybe"	"I save things to stop seeing them"	No
	C10.4	The wishlist is used as a price-tracking tool rather than a purchase list	"I add it to watch the price"	N/A
	C10.5	The wishlist is used as a temporary comparison workspace during a session, never revisited	Bulk saves in one sitting, no returns	N/A
	C10.6	Saved for someone else (gift, family member) where the decision doesn't rest with the saver	"Saving options for my mom"	Partly
C11. Intent extinguished after saving	C11.1	Desire cooled after the initial impulse	"I don't like it as much now"	Partly
	C11.2	The item, or an acceptable substitute, was bought on another platform or in store	"Got it from Zara instead"	Partly
	C11.3	The need it was intended for has passed or been met another way	"The event's over"	No
	C11.4	On re-viewing, the user realised it duplicates something they already own	"Turns out I have one like this"	Partly

▼ D. Cart-level problem: % users who purchased an item once it is added in the bag. People who haven't purchased the item after clicking on add to cart.

Stage D — Cart-level

Metric: % of add-to-bag users who complete purchase

Population: added to bag, didn't pay

Sub-theme	Hypotheses	Barrier	Note
D1. Cost surprise	Cart H1	Shipping, platform/convenience fee, COD charge, tax revealed late	Survives the no-money constraint — it's a disclosure fix, not a discount
D2. Mechanical friction	(new)	Payment failure, no preferred method, OTP drop, pincode rejected at checkout	Cheapest wins available anywhere in the funnel
D3. Late-revealed terms	(new)	Delivery date too late for the occasion; item turns out non-returnable	Information-timing problem
D4. Final reconsideration	(new)	Basket total triggers second thoughts; cart used as a holding pen	Overlaps C6 — count it once, at D

These are 4 potential areas of opportunity. To choose one of them, we need to know where we find the highest drop-off rate. This requires app data, since it isn't provided in the problem statement, you have to get online user feedback as a proxy to choose one.

AI-discovery engine insights: Theme C had the highest drop offs. It will provide the most likely hypothesis why that might be the case as per the user feedback.

By combining the product outcomes and AI-powered engines findings, we base our segmentation on theme C.

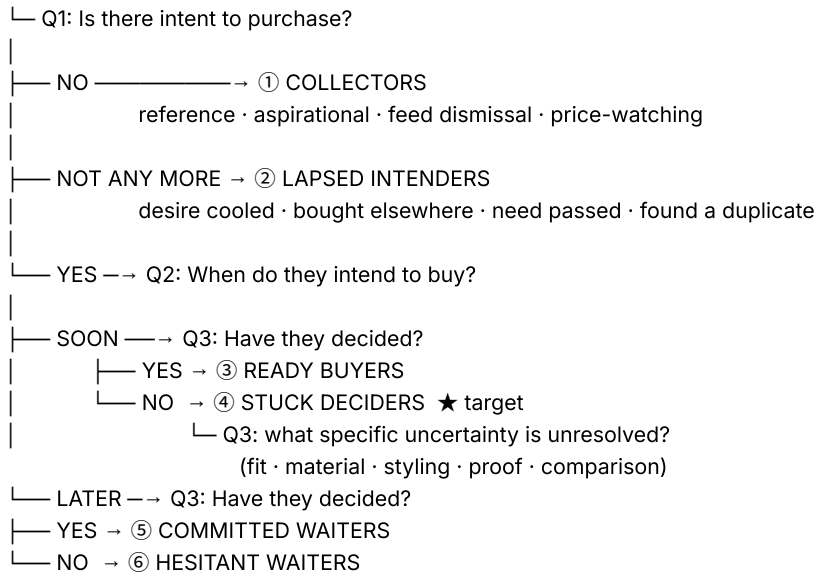
User segmentation: Why do people wishlist items? Based on the wishlisting behaviour we have three segments: (put it in a tree structure)

Segment table:

#	Segment	Q1 Intent	Q2 Horizon	Q3 Decided	Re-engagement (T≤30d)	Urgency	Price sensitivity
①	Collectors	No	—	—	Low — often single view	Zero	N/A
②	Lapsed Intenders	Lapsed	—	—	Was high, now zero	Zero	Varies
③	Ready Buyers	Yes	Soon	Yes	Very high — repeat views, size/stock checks	High	Low — in-band
④	Stuck Deciders ★	Yes	Soon	No	Very high — repeat views, size chart, reviews, near-substitutes saved	High	Moderate has a ban price isn't what's blc
⑤	Committed Waiters	Yes	Later	Yes	Moderate — spikes near the trigger	Low now, high at trigger	Varies by type
⑥	Hesitant Waiters	Yes	Later	No	Moderate — irregular	Low	Reported often overstate

▼ Segmentation rationale:

All users who located a wishlisted item but didn't add to bag
|



Why did we choose this segment?

Impact sizing: Guesstimate the number of [] who purchased a wishlisted item and find how many of them we can convert

How many 'buying-soon' users don't click on add to bag?

Probability of success(difficulty in changing user behaviour)

Ideal Stuck Decider's Behaviour: How should we want the Stuck Deciders to behave?

HMWs based on product outcomes (the goal; the natural momentum in towards the goal):

How might we get 'Stuck Deciders' to click on 'add to bag' once they've located their items in the wishlist?

Hypothesis on why aren't Stuck Deciders clicking on 'add to bag' once they've located their item in the wishlist?

How to generate hypotheses?

We use Stuck Decider's decision-making journey and narrow it down to the most difficult decision that they aren't able to make. That will be your opportunity/user problem

Decision-making journey:

Separating **stages** (what they evaluate) from **channels** (how they seek resolution) is cleaner than either table alone — because friction can sit in either, and the fix differs. A user stuck on fit with no usable reviews has a channel failure; a user with great reviews who still can't map sizes has a stage failure.

▼ Decision journey — Stuck Deciders

Divided into decision-making stages

# Layers/uncertainties	Stage	The question	Criteria evaluated	Why it doesn't resolve
Layer 0 — Do I still want it?				
S1	Desire re-confirmation	"Was this a genuine want or an impulse?"	Still appeals; taste shifted; still current; was the save reactive	The save carries no context — no record of why it was saved or what for — so the user can't re-derive their own reasoning and must re-decide from scratch
Layer 1 — Is it what it appears to be?				

# Layers/uncertainties	Stage	The question	Criteria evaluated	Why it doesn't resolve
S2	Product truth	"Is the real thing like the photos?"	Fabric weight, drape, opacity, stretch; stitch and finish; true colour; wash behaviour	Photographs and a composition string cannot convey tactile properties, so re-looking produces no new evidence
S3	Source trust	"Can I trust this listing?"	Seller reputation; authenticity; whether photos are the actual product	Platform-level trust doesn't transfer to listing level, and nothing distinguishes a reliable listing from a risky one
Layer 2 — Will it work for me?				
S4	Body fit	"Which size, and will it sit right?"	Brand-specific sizing; measurements vs. lived fit; my proportions; past returns; whether only adjacent sizes remain	Generic measurements answer a personal prediction question; no reference maps the user's known fit in one brand onto this one
S5	Aesthetic fit	"Will it look good on <i>me</i> ?"	How it reads on my body type, skin tone, age; model vs. self	Model imagery answers "is this good" not "is this good on me" — a gap looking harder can't close
S6	Purpose fit	"Is it right for what I need it for?"	Occasion appropriateness; formality; season; wear frequency	The page is organised around the item, not the use, so versatility can't be evaluated
S7	Wardrobe fit	"Does it work with what I own?"	Pairings; do I own those pieces; do I already own something similar	The wardrobe exists only in memory, so integration must be simulated mentally — high effort, easily deferred
Layer 3 — Is it the best option?				
S8	Set comparison	"Which of my saved options wins?"	Near-substitutes for the same need; trade-offs across them	A one-item-at-a-time interface applied to an inherently relative choice
S9	Market comparison	"Is something better still out there?"	Alternatives elsewhere; price and style off-platform	No signal that the search is complete, so continuing to look always feels prudent
Layer 4 — Is it worth it?				
S10	Value judgment	"Is it worth this price?"	Inferred quality vs. price; vs. comparable items; vs. what I've paid before	Value is a ratio — unresolved quality doubt (S2) makes it uncomputable even when the price is affordable
S11	Price anchoring	"Is this the same deal I saved?"	Current vs. saved price; direction of movement;	The saved price becomes the reference point, so an increase registers as a loss rather than a neutral change — buying now feels like accepting a worse deal

# Layers/uncertainties	Stage	The question	Criteria evaluated	Why it doesn't resolve
		"Is it available cheaply at other platforms?"	whether a discount lapsed	
Layer 5 — Should I commit now?				
S12	Risk tolerance	"What if I'm wrong?"	Return effort and time; exchange availability; money held up; past return experience	Confidence may be adequate, but the cost of error is high enough that adequate isn't sufficient
S13	Social confirmation	"Do the people who matter agree?"	Partner or friend opinion; group reaction; spend approval	The decision is now blocked on a third party's latency, and the product doesn't know it's waiting
S14	Action trigger	"Why today rather than later?"	Deadline; stock risk; anything making now different	Urgency attaches to the need, never to the decision — deferring stays free and invisible

▼ Resolution channels (cross-cutting)

This is how user acts in each stage to resolve uncertainties:

#	Channel	Predominant failure point	Stages served (question)	Not invoked because...	Doesn't resolve because...	Doesn't return because...	Lo
R1	On-platform evidence ratings, review text, buyer photos, Q&A	Resolution — the channel is reached but the evidence doesn't answer the question	S2 Product truth ("Is the real thing like the photos?") S4 Body fit ("Which size, and will it sit right?") S5 Aesthetic fit ("Will it look good on me?") S6 Purpose fit ("Is it right for what I need it for?")	User doesn't expect reviews to answer their specific question, so doesn't scroll	Too few, too old, photo-less; addresses fit but not fabric; negatives with no way to judge whether they apply to <i>my</i> case	<i>(no exit — resolution is in-place)</i>	In-
R2	Off-platform verification YouTube hauls, Reddit, Instagram, brand research	Return — the doubt often clears, the purchase doesn't follow	S2 Product truth S3 Source trust ("Can I trust this listing?") S4 Body fit S10 Value judgment ("Is it worth this price?")	Doesn't occur to them, or the item isn't worth the effort	Content covers the brand generally, not this SKU; sponsored reviews; contradictory verdicts	The session is over. The answer arrives with no path back and the item is no longer top of mind	Ex
R3	Ask a person screenshot to friend, partner,	Resolution + return — replies are	S4 Body fit S5 Aesthetic fit S7 Wardrobe fit	No one appropriate to ask;	Reply is "nice!" — unstructured,	Reply arrives hours later, detached from	Me ap

#	Channel	Predominant failure point	Stages served (question)	Not invoked because...	Doesn't resolve because...	Doesn't return because...	Lo
	family, group chat	vague when they come, and late when they're useful	("Does it work with what I own?") S13 Social confirmation ("Do the people who matter agree?")	embarrassment about the spend	doesn't address the actual doubt	the item and the buying moment	
R4	Self-reference measuring or comparing a garment they already own	Invocation — rarely thought of, and effortful when it is	S4 Body fit S2 Product truth S7 Wardrobe fit	Doesn't occur to them; requires physical effort at home	Their own garment is a different brand, so the comparison doesn't transfer	Resolution happens away from the phone; they don't come back	Of ho
R5	Physical try-on visiting a store to check fit or fabric	Return — resolves well, then converts offline	S2 Product truth S4 Body fit S5 Aesthetic fit	No store nearby stocking that brand	Store carries different SKUs — only the brand's sizing gets validated, not this item	Buys in-store instead , or the trip resolves it days later	Of
R6	Buy-to-try order it and decide physically	Invocation — gated entirely by perceived return cost	S2 Product truth S4 Body fit S5 Aesthetic fit	Blocked by S12 Risk tolerance ("What if I'm wrong?") — returns feel costly, or the item is non-returnable	<i>(always resolves — that's the point)</i>	<i>(converts — this is a success path)</i>	In-
R7	Switch platform buy the same or a comparable item elsewhere	Return — resolution succeeds on a competitor's product	S9 Market comparison ("Is something better still out there?") S10 Value judgment S12 Risk tolerance	Item not available elsewhere	<i>(resolves — on someone else's product)</i>	Converts on a competitor — resolution succeeded, you lost the sale	Cc
R8	Wait it out <i>the default when everything else fails</i>	Resolution — nothing is attempted, so nothing clears	Any unresolved stage — S1 through S14	<i>(always available — this is what happens when R1–R7 fail)</i>	Nothing resolves; the user just hopes clarity arrives	Never returns with intent; the item goes cold	Nc

Reading the table: each channel is its own three-step funnel — *invoked?* → *resolves?* → *returns?* — so a channel can fail at three distinct points, and the fix differs at each. R1 has no return-path failure because the user never leaves; R2, R3 and R5 all resolve successfully and still lose the sale, which is the distinctive failure mode here.

Two patterns to pull out when you present this. Everything visible in Myntra's data (R1, R6, and partially R8) resolves fast and converts — so their dashboards would show healthy engagement and no evidence of a problem, because every failing channel leaves no in-app trace. That's the argument for why this needed qualitative discovery rather than analytics.

And latency predicts loss better than doubt type does: the same fabric doubt converts when resolved in seconds via R1 and usually doesn't when routed through R2. So the intervention target is **moving resolution from a slow, invisible, external channel into a fast in-app one** — a framing that holds regardless of which stage your interviews say binds.

The Hypothesis space(contains all possible causes why Stuck Deciders won't click on 'add to bag'):

Basis of hypotheses: Which of the five decision layer/step of the Stuck Decider's decision-making journey that they find most difficult, and as a consequence stops them from adding the product to the bag?

H1:

H1.1:

H1.2:

H2:

H2.1:

H2.2:

H2.3:

H2.4:

H3:

H3.1:

H3.2:

H4:

H4.1:

H4.2:

H5:

H5.1:

H5.2:

H5.3:

User research:

Do user research to (in)validate the hypothesis you made about Stuck Deciders: 30+ surveys + 5-6 1:1 focus interview(for statistical significance) with Stuck Deciders to further narrow down to the atomistic opportunities/problems.

Through *survey*, we find out(this is also where we prioritise validated hypotheses): which layer and which stage has higher opportunity/user problem. From surveys, we first filter-in our targeted user segment(stuck-deciders) from our responses, then ask a series of questions that establishes beyond any reasonable doubt which decision layer has highest opportunity/user problem, then dig deeper into that layer to establish beyond any reasonable doubt that which stage has the high problem/opportunity.

We pick that stage and ask deeper questions in 1:1 interviews about it.

Through *1:1 focus interviews*(5-6), we find out(here, we dig deeper to understand why users face that problem; it is qualitative):

How they *articulate* their uncertainty in public

How they *think* about the uncertainty internally

How they *act* to solve those uncertainties — workarounds(here, since Stuck Deciders want to buy so users aren't creating a workaround because of resistance but because the solution/feature is absent; this is a really good sign)

Through interviews, we decide how people are solving for this specific uncertainty(, if there are facing any specific friction points, barriers and blockers during their decision-making journey in app or in general, and if there are any specific workarounds that they have created to avoid them

The length that people go to for solving the uncertainties — What slows them down(time-taken), what takes too much effort(cognitive, physical), what acts as a blocker

Workarounds: The Resolution Channel table

How they *feel* when they solve for this opportunity? — The emotional state while solving for the uncertainty

Pain point — an active, negative conscious feeling of frustration; a symptom; surface-level, tied to a specific tool or a step

Unmet needs — the root cause of the uncertainty (What unmet needs emerge consistently across user conversations?)
(**an unmet need is the structural gap or underlying goal that causes that frustration.** It is the essence of user research. Goals, resistance, friction and pain points, barriers, blockers and workarounds are signals and footprints that leads to unmet needs)

Summarising these findings:

User Personas (profile, context and triggers, goal, friction/barrier, pain-points, workarounds)

JTBD; once the problem is prioritised you summarise your research using JTBD — If you were to summarize your research in a single sentence that sticks then what would it be?

- When I... (context)
- But... (barrier)
- Please help me... (goal)
- So I... (outcome)

Problem framing canvas (summarize the contents of the problem space in it)

What is the true problem?

Who are the customers facing the problem?

How do we know it is a real problem?

What is the value generated by solving this problem?

For the target customers

For the business

Why should we solve this problem now?

▼ Other notes to better understand the framework:

Opportunities (Business pov) = user problems (user pov); Hypotheses = unvalidated opportunities/user problems

You have to pick those opportunities that drive our desired business outcome

You have three ways of spotting opportunities/problems:

- Metrics (if you have an existing product). Track user journey, drop off points etc.
- Talking to (potential) customers to understand pain points
 - analyse online user feedback at scale
 - surveys
 - user interviews
- Looking at macro trends/industry/ecosystem patterns

A **workaround** is a makeshift hack or manual process a user invents to bypass an obstacle and achieve their goal.

Your second question hits on a brilliant product management insight: **users create workarounds for two completely opposite reasons.** They do it both when they are *resisting* a solution and when a solution is *completely missing*.

Scenario A: Workarounds caused by Resistance (Bypassing the App) In this case, the app *has* a solution, but the user rejects it because it introduces too much friction, cognitive load, or change. They create a workaround to **avoid using your feature**. [1]

- **The Motive:** Comfort, speed, or habit preservation.
- **The Behavior:** They revert to old, familiar tools outside of your app.
- **Product Example:** A company launches an advanced, automated AI scheduling tool inside their HR platform. However, the interface is confusing and slow.

◦ *The Workaround:* Employees stop using the app's tool and go back to texting each other on WhatsApp to coordinate shifts. [1]

• **What it tells the PM:** Your feature exists, but the user experience is broken or too complex. **The friction is higher than the benefit.**

Resistance(behavioural) — **Resistance is the user's active or passive pushback against changing their behavior, habits, or tools. resistance is the behavioral defense mechanism** the user deploys to protect themselves from that discomfort/frustration.

Why resistance happens?

Even if your new product is objectively better than their old way of doing things, users will still show resistance due to three main factors: [1, 2]

- **Switching Costs:** The mental, physical, or financial effort required to unlearn an old habit and learn a new software interface.
- **Status Quo Bias:** The psychological preference for the current state of affairs. Humans naturally perceive any change from their baseline as a potential loss.
- **Fear of Failure:** The anxiety that using a new, unfamiliar process might cause them to make a critical mistake at work

Scenario B: Workarounds caused by an Absent Solution (Extending the App) In this case, the user *wants* to use your app, but your app literally cannot do what they need. They create a workaround to **bridge the feature gap** so they can keep using your product. [1, 2]

• **The Motive:** Pure necessity. They love your app enough to put up with the hassle of duct-taping a solution together.

• **The Behavior:** They combine your app with spreadsheets, email hacks, or manual copy-pasting.

• **Product Example:** A small business uses a digital invoice app, but the app lacks a feature to send automated payment reminders to clients.

◦ *The Workaround:* Every Monday morning, the business owner manually exports a CSV file of unpaid invoices, uploads it to Gmail, and uses a mail-merge template to send reminders.

• **What it tells the PM:** This is **gold-standard validation** for your product roadmap. The user is actively spending time and energy to solve a problem. If you build this missing feature natively, they will adopt it instantly.

A barrier or a friction point is an object, tool or a process that slows down the user's action towards their goal

A blocker is an object, tool, step or a process that stops users to achieve their goal

Unmet needs — the root cause of the uncertainty(What unmet needs emerge consistently across user conversations?)
(an unmet need is the structural gap or underlying goal that causes that frustration.)

Goals, resistance, friction and pain points, barriers, blockers and workarounds are signals and footprints that leads to unmet needs — which is the essence of user research. You cannot see an "unmet need" directly because it is latent and abstract. Instead, you look for the observable clues your users leave behind:

[OBSERVABLE CLUES]

- ├─ Blockers & Barriers (The technical & structural walls)
- ├─ Friction Points (The clunky steps & design flaws)
- ├─ Pain Points (The resulting emotional frustration)
- ├─ Resistance (The psychological pushback & habits)
- └─ Workarounds (The behavioral hacks & duct-tape)

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[THE CORE DISCOVERY]

Unmet Needs (The root, solution-agnostic requirement for progress)

How They Connect: A Blueprint

When you conduct user research, you collect these clues to map out the truth:

1. You identify the user's **Goal** (what they are trying to achieve).
2. You map the **Blockers, Barriers, and Friction** built into the current process.
3. You observe their emotional reaction (**Pain Points**) and behavioral pushback (**Resistance**).

4. You catch them using hacks (**Workarounds**) to survive the experience.

5. **The Synthesis:** You look at all of this data and ask: *"What is the fundamental, structural capability missing from their lives that would make all of this disappear?"* That answer is your **Unmet Need**. [1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

The Ultimate Prize

By focusing your user research on these signals, you avoid the biggest trap in product management: **building features just because a user asked for them**. [1, 2]

Instead, you uncover the root requirements. This allows your engineering and design teams to build elegant, innovative solutions that users didn't even know were possible—but instantly cannot live without.

Hypothesis (user problem/opportunities; barriers, blockers, friction points, pain points that restricts/prevents user's movement towards the goal) (How to generate hypothesis? First, your own experience, then analyse online user feedback, then a survey to validate the findings at scale, then talk to 5-6 users deeply. Does it guarantee all possible hypotheses? No. But this is the only way we know. That means, there is a chance that we might even miss the core problem/opportunity just bcs we couldn't conceptualised it. It's better if you list out all possible hypothesis so that you get a better understanding of user behaviour and the problem statement)

Solution space:

Three solution ideas

Prioritised Solution (a product idea that eliminated the user problem so that they can naturally move towards their goal, that is, purchasing a wishlisted item)

User flow

Wireframes, Prototype

Success metrics, Risks and Mitigation

About AI-Powered Discovery Engine

It is a PM's autonomous research partner which uses the scientific method and PM methodology to discover new knowledge about products, users or any specific problem a PM might have.

Constraint: This engine is tied only to one problem — Discover the underlying user problem that acts a barrier/friction/resistance for increasing the wishlist-to-purchase conversion for Myntra

Your workflow should go beyond summarizing reviews or performing sentiment analysis. It should enable you to **identify, quantify where possible, and compare potential opportunity areas** that could influence the stated business metric.

It follows this loop:

Step 1: Gathers user feedback online — real user feedback from app reviews, reddit discussions, social media conversations, Youtube comments, fashion and shopping communities, academic/credible corporate research on user behaviour of this industry or any relevant research on this industry, product reviews and Q&A where relevant, other publicly available conversations about online fashion shopping

Product: Data Bank: It organises the collected data and lets the users access it through the app

Step 2: Using a PM's knowledge base and it's analytical framework, it analyzes the data, finds patterns, hidden relationships between multiple variables/factors, themes, affinities, clusters, sentiments and visually/graphically represents them in a clear way

App user journey, hypotheses

Step 3: Using a PM's knowledge base/expertise, generate insights and then hypotheses on the underlying user problem that acts as barrier in increasing the wishlist-to-purchase conversion while citing sources, references and discovered

insights as the rationale.

Step 4: Q/A chatbot— can answer any relevant question regarding the problem statement, analysis, insights, hypotheses, raw data. It should understand the context of the question and judge whether we have the answer for it from above steps. If not, then refuse. If yes, then answer based on data only. If somewhere in between, try to answer those aspects of the question that could be answered using the data.

Your discovery engine should help answer questions such as these and many more:

- Why do users add fashion products to their wishlist?
- What prevents wishlisted products from eventually being purchased?
- What uncertainties remain after users have identified a product they like?
- What causes users to postpone a purchase?
- How do users compare multiple shortlisted products?
- What information do users seek outside Myntra/AJIO before purchasing?
- What role do fit, size, styling, price, reviews, occasion and social validation play?
- When do users use the wishlist as genuine purchase intent versus simply as a bookmarking mechanism?
- How do these behaviors differ across user segments?
- What unmet needs emerge consistently across user conversations?